Questions to Ask

Leading with AI. The questions from every session, for your vendors, your IT and data teams, and your board. Take this page to the next AI proposal.

Session 1: AI that sees and reads: images, documents and speech

Ask	Why it matters
What photos, pages or recordings did it learn from?	It only knows the kind it was shown
Were they like ours: our cameras, forms, languages, light?	A new kind of image breaks it
How often is it right on our own samples?	The vendor's score was on their images
What does it do with a photo it cannot read?	A good tool says "not sure"
Who checks what it flags, and who reviews a "no" about a person?	People answer for the decision
Where do our images and recordings go?	Photos and voices can be personal data

Session 2: AI that predicts from your data

Ask	Why it matters
What records did it learn from, and how many of each outcome?	A rare outcome with few examples gives a weak model
What was the score on records it never saw?	The score on records it has seen flatters
Who set the cut-off, and what does moving it cost?	Every cut-off trades risk against work
What has changed since those records were made?	A new product or a drought breaks the pattern
Who decides the close calls, and can a customer ask why?	Customers expect a reason; check your legal duties
How will we know, each month, that it still works?	Patterns drift as the world changes

Session 3: Is it any good? Accuracy claims and the cost of mistakes

Ask	Why it matters
How rare is the thing it looks for, in cases like ours?	When it is rare, accuracy flatters
Of the real cases, how many does it catch?	Each miss costs a loss
Of its alarms, how many are real?	Each false alarm costs work and goodwill
Measured on which cases: learned-from, kept aside, or ours?	Only unseen and own cases are fair
How does it compare with doing nothing, and with our current rule?	A tool must beat the simple option
Are the mistakes spread evenly across groups?	Bias hides inside a good total

Session 4: AI that understands language: sort, search, translate and summarise

Ask	Why it matters
Which languages does it handle, and was it tested on ours?	Quality falls where a language has little text

Ask	Why it matters
How often is it right on our own messages, ones it never saw?	The vendor's demo text is cleaner than yours
Does it show the top few results and the source passage?	A person can then choose and check
How does it handle slang, spelling slips and mixed languages?	Customers write the way they speak
Where do our messages and documents go, and who can read them?	Contracts and complaints hold personal data
How does a customer reach a person, and how fast?	Loops with no exit lose customers

Session 5: Generative AI: how chatbots write, and why they sometimes invent

Ask	Why it matters
Where do our prompts and documents go, and are they kept?	Staff paste in customer and company data
Can it answer from our own documents and show the source?	Answers from memory invent more
How often does it invent on our kind of questions?	Test it on twenty questions with known answers
Who checks and signs what it drafts?	The organisation answers for it
What happens when it does not know?	A good tool says so, and routes to a person
Who tests it again after each update?	DPD's bot changed after an update